

4. Monitors

Sometimes there is a bad batch of display panels manufactured, rather than dump that batch it is still put up for sale at a low price. Companies use these displays to come out with low-end monitors. These panels don't support standard resolutions out of the box so signals are converted to overcome the defect that these panels have. The signal from the GPU to the monitor's logic board is at a native resolution but it is then scaled up/down to suit whatever the resolution the monitor supports. What we get is a distorted image, with the same letters ending up with different widths and all sorts of weird anomalies on the display. What's not fine is that this fact is not declared by companies on the products. So if you're getting a monitor at a really cheap rate, then there is a good chance that there was something wrong with it.

<http://dgit.in/ROLMRm>

5. Choice for a higher price

Take the example of external HDDs. The difference in prices of the USB-SATA interface ICs for USB 2.0 and USB 3.0 is minimal, roughly 70-90 cents. Yet the cost of the finished product varies by a few hundred rupees.

Also many external HDDs come bundled with USB 2.0 interface, and opting for the USB 3.0 interface connectors costs as much as '1,700 more!

Maybe you fancy a FireWire interface instead, sure, you can have that too, '2,450 *only*! Then again, if you just have to have the latest in technology, a Thunderbolt adapter is yours for a mere '6600.

<http://dgit.in/QFlmu5>

6. Broken promises

Everybody was looking forward to the shiny new features of the PS3 when it launched, but it was also loved for its backwards compatibility. Here you had a brand new console with a completely revamped architecture that would still easily play all your old PS2 games as well. Then came the PS3 slim – and you could forget about PS2 game compatibility, as the "Graphics Synthesizer" GPU was removed. This was fine, after all it was preceded by thorough market research.

What ticked off the consumers was when Sony with its 3.21 firmware update removed the ability to install another OS (usually a flavour of Linux) on to the console – all in the name of security. This was a feature which was well-marketed earlier, and many of us had bought PS3's for just this reason. Of course the firmware update was "optional", but it meant that you couldn't play any of the new games. Class action lawsuits soon followed, but Sony won.

<http://dgit.in/Pgrhv8>

7. Flagship woes

Going in for a flagship product makes you feel like you will be treated with a little more love than the rest of the commoners, doesn't it. You expect to have longer support as well, after all, you did pay top-dollar! Alas, if only all companies would do so.

Owners of Windows phone flagship devices such as the Nokia Lumia 900 and 800 – which people paid in excess of '40,000 for – were greatly disappointed when they heard the news that their devices would not support the upcoming Windows Phone 8 OS. Boo! The same goes

TOTAL RECALL...

With all the competition and consumers demanding better products at low prices, the manufacturers have to make some compromise. Usually it's something that wouldn't catch the average joe's eye until something bad happens. So while your product may look all shiny and new, it might have low quality cheap components on the inside which are bound to fail.

Developed countries have government and private watchdogs which scrutinise each product before it enters the market, whereas in India it was only in November 2011 that the government started mulling over having a watchdog for the food sector. The same for technology is ages away. Global trends about product recalls are appalling and in the recent years, the number of product recalls have shot through the roof. It is of utmost importance that we have a system in place for monitoring goods and laying down strict standards for everything.

<http://dgit.in/OfgXjy>

for Apple users who bought the iPhone 4. Just over a year later, the iPhone 4S came with Siri, everyone's favourite girlfriend!

Now it may have been over a year for early adopters in the West, but we know of many disgruntled Indians who waited months to get their hands on an iPhone 4, only to feel like idiots a few months later. Of course, some enterprising chaps have



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